

Bean soup, light

Franny Glass, 9 November 2025

Fills a large (8 qt) Instant Pot to about 6 quarts.

Ingredients

Essential

2 lb dry beans (great northern or 7-bean mix)	4–8 garlic cloves, minced
2–3 large onions, diced	3–4 medium waxy potatoes, diced
3–4 carrots, diced	3–4 Tbsp vegetable Better Than Bouillon
3–4 celery stalks, diced	2–3 Tbsp olive or avocado oil

Optional

8–12 oz mushrooms, chopped	2–3 Tbsp tomato paste
1–2 Tbsp gochugaru or 2–3 banana peppers, chopped	Arugula, kale, or chard (stir in at the end)
3–4 Tbsp MCT oil	Thyme, oregano
2–3 Tbsp liquid aminos or soy sauce	Miso paste (add at the end)
Several bay leaves	Greens (<i>e.g.</i> , beet, dandelion)
Apple cider vinegar or lemon juice (to finish)	Smoked paprika (for smokey depth)

Instructions

Prep Rinse beans and remove any junk (*e.g.*, rocks). Rinse and cut other ingredients as desired.

Sauté aromatics Set Instant Pot to sauté. Add olive or avocado oil. Sweat onions, garlic, and half of the carrots and celery for 5–10 minutes (do not brown). Add mushrooms and cook 2–3 minutes more. Stir in tomato paste and toast for 2 minutes.

Build base Add beans, banana peppers or gochugaru, herbs (if using), bouillon, and enough water to reach the 6 quart mark. Add liquid aminos or soy sauce. Stir to combine. Count and lay bay leaves on top.

Pressure cook Cook on high pressure for 35–40 minutes. Allow natural release at least 20 minutes, then quick release any remaining pressure.

Add potatoes and finish Stir. Add potatoes and remaining carrot and celery. Set to sauté or slow cook for 15–20 minutes, until potatoes are just tender. Season to taste.

Finish and adjust Stir in MCT oil. Mash some beans or potatoes against the side if the soup is too brothy. Add salt as needed.

Notes

Serving Finish with black pepper and vinegar or lemon juice. Consider adding arugula, kale, or chard.

Variations Add smoked paprika for depth, but balance by finishing the soup with additional acid.